

WHEN IT GOES DARK · FREE PRINTABLE

THE BLACKOUT CHECKLIST

Page 1: what to have before the power goes out. Page 2: what to do when it does.

HAVE IT BEFORE IT GOES DARK

AT LEAST 3 DAYS OF SUPPLIES

WATER & FOOD

- [ ] **Water: 1 gallon per person, per day**, for at least 3 days (drinking and sanitation)
- [ ] Extra water for pets
- [ ] At least 3 days of food that needs no fridge and no cooking
- [ ] Manual can opener

LIGHT, POWER & NEWS

- [ ] A flashlight or headlamp for each person (safer than candles)
- [ ] Extra batteries for all of it
- [ ] Battery-powered or hand-crank radio (a NOAA weather radio if you can)
- [ ] Phone charger and a charged power bank
- [ ] Surge protector for your electronics

HEALTH

- [ ] First aid kit
- [ ] Medicines, plus a plan with your doctor for medicines that need a fridge
- [ ] A plan for any medical device that needs power
- [ ] Pet food and supplies

SAFETY & PAPERWORK

- [ ] **Carbon monoxide alarm** that runs on batteries or has battery backup
- [ ] Some cash (card readers can go down too)
- [ ] Copies of IDs and insurance in a waterproof bag
- [ ] A paper list of important phone numbers

> **Live in a high-rise?** In some buildings, electric pumps push water up to the higher floors. No power can mean no water up there, so fill containers early when a storm is coming.

MY NUMBERS

Power company outage line: _____

Out-of-area contact: _____

Doctor / pharmacy: _____

Neighbor to check on: _____

Lando's job: stay out of the fridge. (He will not.)

Sources: Ready.gov (Power Outages; Build a Kit), CDC (Use a Generator Safely; Carbon Monoxide Detectors), FoodSafety.gov (Food Safety During Power Outages). General information, not professional advice. In an emergency, follow your local officials and call 911. · @whenitgoesdarktv

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WHEN IT GOES DARK

The first moves, and the mistakes that hurt people during outages.

THE FIRST HOUR

1. **Keep the fridge and freezer closed.** A closed fridge keeps food safe for up to **4 hours**. A full freezer holds about **48 hours** (about 24 if it's half full).
2. **Unplug electronics and appliances** so a power surge can't damage them when the power comes back.
3. **Use flashlights, not candles.**
4. **Check on family and neighbors**, if it's safe to do so. Older neighbors and people on medical devices first.
5. **Save your phone:** low power mode, brightness down. Get news from the radio.

The quiet killer: carbon monoxide. Run generators, grills and camp stoves **outside only, at least 20 feet** from doors, windows and vents. Never inside your home, garage or carport. **Never** heat your home with a gas stove, oven, grill or dryer. Headache, dizziness, weakness, an upset stomach or confusion can be CO poisoning: get to fresh air and call 911.

FOOD

- [ ] Throw out meat, poultry, fish, eggs and leftovers after **4 hours** without power
- [ ] When in doubt, throw it out
- [ ] Never taste food to check if it's safe

MEDICINE

- [ ] Power out a day or more? Replace fridge medicines unless the label says otherwise
- [ ] Ask your doctor before the next outage, not during it

HEAT

- [ ] Go to an air-conditioned place if you can
- [ ] Wet your skin, wear light-colored clothes, avoid heavy activity

COLD

- [ ] Plan where you'll spend the coldest hours somewhere with heat
- [ ] Layers and blankets. No ovens or grills for heat

Stay or leave? If your home gets too hot, too cold, or unsafe, going to a place with power (a friend, family, or a community center officials open) is the smart move, not giving up.

New survival story every day. You vote what happens next: @whenitgoesdarktv

Sources: Ready.gov (Power Outages), CDC (Use a Generator Safely; Avoiding Carbon Monoxide Poisoning), FoodSafety.gov (Food Safety During Power Outages). General information, not professional advice. In an emergency, follow your local officials and call 911. · © When It Goes Dark